



Golden volvox,
Worldwide

Green alga

A single drop of water could hold all of the beautiful spheres you see here. Each spotty ball is a green alga called golden volvox. They are found drifting through freshwater puddles and ponds. Green algae (al-gee) make food from the Sun's energy using the same chemical as plants. This chemical, called chlorophyll (klor-roh-fill), is also what gives them their colour.

Green algae are a huge group of organisms. Usually they are tiny and have a single cell – to see them, you need a microscope. However, they may live together as green slime, or grow as green seaweed. Some even live on animals such as sloths and manatees, making them look green!